

1851–1900

1858

Responding to persecution of Catholics, France and Spain invade southern Vietnam. The French stay to create the colony of Cochin China in 1864.

DECEMBER 1883

A French expeditionary force invading Tonkin (northern Vietnam) defeats Chinese “Black Flag” irregulars at the Battle of Son Tay.



Battle of Son Tay, 1883

1885

After battling Vietnamese and Chinese forces, the French establish a protectorate over Tonkin and Annam (central Vietnam), which is ratified by the Treaty of Tientsin.

1887

French Indochina is created as an administrative union of Tonkin, Annam, Cochin China, and Cambodia. Laos is added to French Indochina in 1893.